▼ GLASSHOUSE



SPIRITUAL BALLAST

War, spirituality and geopolitics. **Army chief Gen. Upendra Dwivedi** got a taste of all three during a post-Operation Sindoor visit to the Rambhadracharya ashram in Chitrakoot, MP, in late May. The Army chief and wife Sunita had driven down from Prayagraj, where he had spent time with the crack Red Eagle Infantry division, to seek the blessings of Jagadguru Rambhadracharya. The seer compared the army chief's mission to that of Lord Hanuman's to Lanka, suggesting that he had received the same *deeksha* (initiation) through the Ram Mantra. And as a symbolic "*guru dakshina*", Rambhadracharya asked that he "get back PoK" for India.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ ROYAL EDIT

QUICK REWRITE

The old barbs about Rajasthan deputy CM **Diya Kumari's** ancestors are seeing a seasonal revival, with special mentions going to Raja Bharmal, who is said to have married his daughter off to Akbar, and Raja Man Singh, who fought on the side of the Mughal emperor against Maharana Pratap at the Battle of Haldighati. But that's in the past and when democracy had its say



in 2019, the lady was elected as MP from Rajsamand, the Rajput heartland seat that includes Haldighati and Pratap's birthplace, Kumbhalgarh. But though she has won elections since, the jibes never went away. Finally, the princess decided it was time for retort. At an event marking the 485th birth anniversary of Maharana Pratap, she said: "I don't speak much, but when I do, it carries weight. I had the ASI inscription changed from 'Pratap retreated…' to saying 'he won the battle'." Guess that's enough history lessons for this week.